

Mónica Vasco

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🌐 <https://vascomonica.github.io/>

🔍 Experimental and behavioral economics, social networks, lab-in-the-field experiments, economics of education.



Education

- Sep. 2024 – now 📖 **Postdoc**, Los Angeles Behavioral Economics Laboratory, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, USA.
- Dec. 2021 – Jul. 2024 📖 **Ph.D Data Science**, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain.
Title: *Decision-making and networks among adolescents*
Pre-doctoral stay (2023) at Essex University, UK
- Sep. 2021 – Jul. 2022 📖 **MSc. Economics: Empirical Applications and Policies**, Basque Country University, Bilbao, Spain. Title: *School bullying and social networks*.
- Oct. 2020 – Jul. 2021 📖 **MRes Social Sciences Methods** Loyola Andalucía University, Sevilla, Spain.
Title: *Cognitive abilities, risk-taking and inconsistent choices among teenagers*.
- Sep. 2015 – Jun. 2020 📖 **B.A. Business Administration** Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain.
Erasmus (2018) at Derby University, UK
- 📖 **B.A. Law** Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain.

Employment History

- Sep. 2024 – now 📖 **Project Specialist (Postdoc)**
Los Angeles Behavioral Economics Laboratory, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, USA
- Dic. 2021 – Jul. 2024 📖 **Research Assistant (FPU)**
Loyola Behavioural Lab, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain
- Jan. 2020 – Jun. 2021 📖 **Internship**
Economics Department, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain

Research Publications

Published papers

- 1 Vasco, M., Alfonso, A., Arenas, A., Cabrales, A., Cuesta, J. A., Espín, A. M., ... Brañas-Garza, P. (2025). Economic preferences and cognitive abilities among teenagers in Spain. *Scientific Data*, 12, 7. [doi:10.1038/s41597-024-04298-6](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-024-04298-6)
- 2 Vasco, M., & Vázquez-De Francisco, M. J. (2025). Holt-laury as a gumball machine. *PLoS ONE*, 20(4), e0320576. [doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0320576](https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0320576)
- 3 Alfonso, A., Brañas-Garza, P., Jorrot, D., Lomas, P., Prissé, B., Vasco, M., & Vázquez-De Francisco, M. J. (2023). The adventure of running experiments with teenagers. *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*, 102048. [doi:10.1016/j.socec.2023.102048](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socec.2023.102048)

Work in progress

- 1 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., Rajaomason, M., & Vasco, M. (2026). *Leadership legitimacy, inequality, and protests: A network experiment with university students in Madagascar*. [Data collected](#).

- 2 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., & Vasco, M. (2026). *Development of protective behavior and contagion reasoning in a dynamic network SIS game*. [Data collected](#).
- 3 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., Derex, M., & Vasco, M. (2025). *Learning and information transfer: Evidence from an intuitive physics task*. [To be submitted](#).
- 4 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., Rios, U., & Vasco, M. (2025). *The microfoundations of herding behavior: Learning, signals, and connectivity in children's networks*. [In writing](#).
- 5 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., & Vasco, M. (2025a). *Measuring theory of mind in children and adolescents*. [Data collected](#).
- 6 Brocas, I., Carrillo, J. D., & Vasco, M. (2025b). *Networked decision-making and social learning in children and adolescents*. [In writing](#).
- 7 Brocas, I., & Vasco, M. (2025). *Friendship, enmity, and in-between: Dimensions of social relationships across development*. [Data collection ongoing](#).
- 8 Kovářík, J., Hsieh, C.-S., & Vasco, M. (2025). *Gender differences in friendship networks (across the globe)*. [In writing](#).
- 9 Brañas-Garza, P., Cabrales, A., Kovářík, J., & Vasco, M. (2024). *The social footprint of bullying: Evidence from signed peer nominations and tie strength*. [Submitted](#).
- 10 Brañas-Garza, P., Kovářík, J., Mengel, F., & Vasco, M. (2024). *Seeing less than there is: Misperceptions of social network structure*. [To be submitted](#).

Teaching

- 23/24  **Econometrics** (Instructor of Record, taught in English). Business Administration Department, Loyola Andalucía University.
-  **Microeconomics III** (Teaching Assistant, taught in Spanish). Economics Department, Loyola Andalucía University.
- 22/23  **Growth and Development Economics** (Instructor of Record, taught in Spanish). International Relations Department, Loyola Andalucía University.
-  **Microeconomics III** (Teaching Assistant, taught in Spanish). Economics Department, Loyola Andalucía University.

Presentations and research seminars

- Jul. 2026  Borchard Colloquium, Château de la Bretesche, Missillac, France
- Jun. 2026  WEAI 101st Annual Conference, Denver, Colorado, USA
- Apr. 2026  11th annual conference on Network Science in Economics, Miami, Florida, USA
- Oct. 2025  Los Angeles Experiments (LAX) Workshop, Los Angeles, California, USA
-  Economics Science Association (ESA), Tucson, Arizona, USA
- Jan. 2025  Experimental Economics Conference, Bogotá, Colombia
- Oct. 2024  Economics Science Association (ESA), Columbus, Ohio, USA
- Sep. 2024  Los Angeles Experiments (LAX) Workshop, Pasadena, California, USA
- Feb. 2024  Southern Europe Experimental Team's Meeting (SEET), Málaga, Spain
- Sep. 2023  Economics Science Association (ESA), Exeter University, Exeter, UK
- Jun. 2023  IAREP-SABE 47th International Conference, Université Côte d'Azur, Nice, France
- Jan. 2023  Graduate Student Workshop in Experimental Economics, Chapman University, USA

Presentations and research seminars (continued)

- Jun. 2022  Conference on Human Capital Investments, Loyola Andalucía University, Córdoba, Spain
- Jun. 2021  e3c LATAM PhD Workshop, Universitat Illes Balears, Balearic Islands, Spain

Funding

- Dec. 2021 – Nov. 2025  **FPU**, PhD grant (FPU20/05846)
Spanish Ministry of Universities
- Dic. 2022 – Nov. 2024  **Between & Within science based advise**, (PDC2022-133230-I00)
Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation
IPs: Pablo Brañas
- Sep. 2021 – Aug. 2025  **Decisions, Education, Networks and Teenagers**, (PID2021-126892NB-I00)
Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation
IPs: Pablo Brañas and Antonio Cabrales

Skills

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| Languages |  English (fluent), Spanish (native) |
| Software |  R (RStudio), Stata, oTree, Qualtrics, Matlab, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Knime, Weka |
| Quantitative Methods |  Econometrics, Experimental Design, Social Network Analysis, Causal Inference, Survey Design, Lab-in-the-Field Experiments |
| Research & Project Management |  Coordination of field experiments, data collection management, IRB compliance, participant recruitment and incentives, collaboration with schools and research teams |

References

Pablo Brañas (advisor)

Professor of Behavioural Economics
Universidad Loyola Andalucía
 branasgarza@gmail.com

Jaromír Kovářik (co-advisor)

Associate Professor of Behavioural Economics
Universidad del País Vasco
 jaromir.kovarik@ehu.es

Antonio Cabrales

Professor of Economics (Research Chair)
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid
 antonio.cabrales@uc3m.es

Isabelle Brocas

Professor of Economics
University of Southern California
 brocas@usc.edu